

Tobias Treppmann

AI Design Leader — moving closer to the model: behavior, evals, agent workflows

LOCATION Berlin, Germany

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PROFILE

I lead design functions, and I spent the last year working at the model layer. At Bibel TV a support copilot is live in production, and I built an AI fundraising system solo, end to end. At Aperto I designed and directed the nine-criterion panel that judges its output — no golden set, on purpose.

An eval apparatus designed and directed

nine criteria, each judged in its own model call, any single failure rejecting the candidate — and no golden set, because the reference key started with was hiding failures

AI in production, not demoed

a support copilot live for a customer-service team, a fundraising ecosystem built solo end to end, and prototypes an external engineering agency ships from

EXPERIENCE

Head of Product Design

2025 – Present

Bibel TV (broadcaster in linear-to-streaming transformation — iOS, Android, web and connected TV) Hamburg + Berlin, Germany

- AI support copilot, live in production. A Microsoft Copilot skill designed and scoped, platform-configured rather than custom-built. Drafts in the support handbook's wording, formatting and standard phrases.
- Refusal is part of the design. An explicit restricted-topic list sits in the system prompt, and the draft is suppressed entirely when the input is not a viewer enquiry.
- Every send decision stays human. The copilot is operated manually and embedded in nothing, so a person has already read the letter before the model sees it.
- AI fundraising ecosystem, built solo end to end. Analysis of past letters against their performance, a Claude Project that asks clarifying questions before generating, then a production Claude skill.
- Agentic engineering as a design practice. Prototype in real code against real production APIs, and an external engineering agency ships from that code.
- Design system as an API. DTCG tokens in four tiers, built to serve iOS, Android, web and connected TV from one source.
- No in-house design team, so I own UI quality and consistency across iOS, Android, web and connected TV, with nobody to delegate it to. Product managers and product owners build day to day, and an external engineering agency ships from my prototype code across a company boundary.

Founder

2025 – Present

Aperto (aperto.bible) — open translation tooling and a multilingual AI content pipeline Berlin, Germany · independent

- An evaluation panel for model output. Nine criteria, each judged in its own model call with no shared context, binary, any single failure rejecting the candidate.
- No golden set, and that was a decision. A reference key existed and was removed after it hid eight of eleven failures on a chapter it passed.
- The judge's reasons go back to the generator. A closed loop applies the findings, validates the output and re-judges until it converges.
- Statistical judges run alongside the model judges, style-distance against a reference-author corpus, documented as a floor rather than a verdict.
- Prompt changes are validated by pre-registered A/B experiments, with the control arm verified byte-identical. Designed and directed; implemented with AI coding agents.

Head of Platform and Design

2024 – 2025

ChurchDesk (vertical ERP for churches and dioceses — DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH) Copenhagen, Denmark · Remote from Berlin

- Booking built into the platform, not beside it. Scoped internally as a standalone add-on. Built on the existing calendar and form builder instead, so one build carried room rentals, baptisms and weddings.
- 70% less coordination time, 90% acceptance at the launch customer, where funerals had to be bookable for and by 20+ cemeteries. Then shipped to the whole customer base.
- A legal deadline met automatically. Customers running their sites on the platform got a capability that met a new accessibility law for them, across six countries.

Head of Product Design · Interim Head of Product

2023 – 2024

Ninox Software GmbH (no-code business platform — DACH / UK / US) Berlin, Germany

- Two functions at once, nine reports, four disciplines. Product Design and Product held together from July to October 2023. Senior Leadership Team throughout.
- Hired two, promoted two. Developed a levelling framework covering design and UX writing, used for growth plans and level requirements.
- Owned the design system and established joint governance with engineering, a working group of four designers and engineers.
- Returned in 2025 as an independent consultant through Oratio&Co, designing the prompt-to-database AI onboarding model with the CEO and technical co-founder. The generated schema renders into the real data-model editor, not a chat preview — it became the basis for Ninox's public AI beta.

Product & UX Strategist

2021 – 2022

Hypoport hub SE (shared services arm of listed Hypoport SE) Berlin / Lübeck, Germany · Remote

- Executive-level mandate in a 100+ -person shared-services organization. Partnered directly with the executive team; held the Facilitator and Secretary constitutional roles in the company's Holacracy governance.
- Service-to-product transformation. Turning case-by-case support into a standard catalog.
- Service desk from the inside. Worked with the IT department on the ITSM and service-desk implementation, the internal operations tooling for the rest of the group.

Director of Design

2016 – 2021

Datameer GmbH (collaborative data analytics for top US / CA / UK banks and insurers) Berlin, Germany · team across Germany and NYC

- Research inside regulated institutions. Pioneered iterative usertesting.com screening to reach analysts working inside top US, Canadian and UK banks and insurers.

- Led the design team across Germany and NYC for five years. Two UX designers reporting to me, across a six-hour gap, with the cross-timezone processes established.

EARLIER CAREER PROGRESSION

UX Strategy Lead · *Spreadshirt* · 2014 – 2016 · Leipzig, Germany

UX Manager · *HairDirect* · 2013 – 2014 · Lancaster, PA, USA

User Experience Designer · *andCulture* · 2012 – 2013 · Harrisburg, PA, USA

Web Designer & Front-End Developer · *HOPE International* · 2009 – 2012 · Lancaster, PA, USA

EDUCATION

M.A. Leadership

Kairos University, South Dakota, USA

Completed 2026

LANGUAGES

German · native

English · C2, fluent

SKILLS

AI chops — model behavior, evals, agent workflows

A nine-criterion binary rubric, each criterion judged in an isolated model call · judge rationales returned to the generator inside a closed revision loop · judge-drift calibration · pre-registered A/B probes with byte-identical controls · no golden set, deliberately · a production agent's system prompt, restricted-topic list and refusal rule · follow-up-question loops before generation

Building

Prototyping in real code against real production APIs, with an external engineering agency shipping from that code · Claude Code, Claude Projects, Claude skills · structured retrieval over a chunked corpus, built without embeddings or a vector store · SwiftUI · Kotlin · React

Design leadership

Nine reports across four disciplines at Ninox, on the Senior Leadership Team · hired two, promoted two · a levelling framework developed for design and UX writing · coaching a design lead through a hard cross-functional relationship · led the Datameer design team across Germany and NYC for five years

Design systems and cross-platform

Design system as an API · DTCG tokens in four tiers, Style Dictionary, built to serve iOS, Android, web and connected TV from one source · a color engine in OKLCH with WCAG contrast validated inside the algorithm · Storybook · Figma Variables

Product and research

Product management and product ownership for the Bibel TV redesign alongside design · product management for the main platform at ChurchDesk · iterative usertesting.com screening for hard-to-reach personas inside regulated institutions · multi-country delivery across DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH · German native, English C2